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### Mattress with stacked air chambers

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#### Abstract

Disclosed are beds having stackable air chambers. A mattress can include a first air chamber, a second air chamber stacked beneath the first air chamber and fluidly connected to the first air chamber, and a support stacked beneath the first air chamber and positioned between the second air chamber and a foot end of the mattress. The first air chamber can extend across a length of the mattress from a head end to the foot end of the mattress. The second air chamber can be positioned at a shoulder region of the mattress. The first and second air chambers can have a common internal pressure, such that decreasing the pressure in the first and second air chambers cause the support stacked beneath the first air chamber and positioned between the second air chamber and the foot end of the mattress to increase support at a lumbar region of the mattress.

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**Inventors:** Karschnik; Kody Lee (Plymouth, MN), Chhapparwal; Saurabh (Plymouth, MN)

**Applicant:** Sleep Number Corporation (Minneapolis, MN)

**Family ID:** 1000008821432

**Assignee:** Sleep Number Corporation (Minneapolis, MN)

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*Primary Examiner:* Sun; George

*Attorney, Agent or Firm:* Fish & Richardson P.C.

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## Background/Summary

CROSS-REFERENCE TO RELATED APPLICATIONS (1) This application claims priority to U.S. Provisional Application Ser. No. 63/223,235, filed on Jul. 19, 2021, the disclosure of which is incorporated by reference in its entirety.

### TECHNICAL FIELD

(1) This document describes devices, systems, and methods related to mattresses with air chambers.

### BACKGROUND

(2) In general, a bed is a piece of furniture used for sleeping and relaxing. Many modern beds include a soft mattress on a bed frame. The mattress may include springs, foam material, and/or air chambers to support the weight of one or more users. Various features and systems have been used in conjunction with beds, including pressure adjustment systems for adjusting firmness of one or more users of the bed.

### SUMMARY

(3) The document generally relates to mattresses with multiple interconnected air chambers that can be spaced by foam or some other intermediary structure other than the air chambers. More specifically, the document relates to air mattress systems with a plurality of air chambers that can be stacked and positioned in such a way to provide support and sleeper spine alignment through a

full range of firmness pressure settings.

(4) Pressure distribution and support (e.g., spine alignment) can be impacted in differing ways when a firmness is increased or decreased for an air mattress system. In some air mattress systems, when air pressure is decreased in air chambers of the mattress, the mattress can become more comfortable but spine alignment can be reduced. Reduced spine alignment can cause decompression in portions of the user's body, which can negatively impact the user's sleep quality.

(5) Some embodiments described herein include an air mattress system, which can have adjustable stacked air chambers designed to increase or decrease surface firmness while providing spine alignment and comfort for the user. The air chambers can be stacked and configured in a way to allow for improved pressure distribution while also targeting a supportive result for one or more users of the mattress system. For example, in some embodiments, two air chambers can be stacked at a shoulder region of the mattress system while maintaining one air chamber near the waist region. This configuration can be advantageous to provide for more support, pressure adjustment, spinal alignment, and/or user comfort preferences. Stacking chambers in the shoulder region of the mattress system can be advantageous to provide additional support to the shoulder region. In other embodiments, air chambers can be stacked wherever the user desires to have additional or more support and/or adjustability in pressure. For example, one user can prefer stacking air chambers near a hip or waist region of the mattress system to provide more support and adjustment to the hip or waist region. In some embodiments, the user can prefer stacking air chambers that extend substantially across an entire length of the mattress system.

(6) In some embodiments, the stacked air chambers can be fluidly connected such that they share a common pressure. Moreover, in some embodiments, all the air chambers in the mattress system, whether or not they are stacked, can be fluidly connected to share a common pressure. In some embodiments, all the air chambers can be separately adjustable and therefore not share a common pressure. In some embodiments, for example, the air chamber at the waist region can be fluidly connected to one or more of the stacked air chambers at the shoulder region and can be independent of the other air chambers at the shoulder region such that the other air chambers at the shoulder region can be set to different pressures.

(7) In some embodiments, a first air chamber can extend from a head region to a foot region of the mattress system. Above or below the first air chamber, one or more additional air chambers can be stacked in regions of interest of the mattress system. For example, a second air chamber can be stacked in the shoulder region of the mattress system to provide additional support and pressure adjustment in the shoulder region of the mattress system. As another example, a third air chamber can be stacked in the hip region of the mattress system to provide additional support and pressure adjustment in the hip region of the mattress system. In some embodiments, the first and second air chambers can be positioned in the mattress system as mentioned above but the third air chamber can be excluded. Instead, one or more foam inserts can be positioned next to the second air chamber, in the hip region of the mattress system. The foam inserts can extend from the second air chamber to the foot end of the mattress system. As described above, any of the first, second, and third air chambers can be fluidly connected such that they share a common pressure. In some embodiments, only some of the first, second, and third air chambers can be fluidly connected such that they share a common pressure.

(8) In the mattress systems described herein, space between air chambers can be filled with a foam insert or other similar material and/or structure. In some embodiments, multiple foam inserts can be positioned between the air chambers. In some embodiments, one or more foam inserts can also be positioned between each of the air chambers and the head and/or foot ends of the mattress system. As an example, foam inserts can be positioned between a first air chamber in the shoulder region and a second air chamber in the hip region of the mattress system. A third air chamber can extend a length of the mattress system, from the head end to the foot end of the mattress system, and can be positioned directly on top of the first and second air chambers and the foam inserts. Thus, foam

inserts may not be positioned between stacked air chambers. As another example, foam inserts can be positioned between the first air chamber in the shoulder region and the second air chamber in the hip region of the mattress system. A third air chamber can be stacked on top of the first air chamber in the shoulder region of the mattress system. Additional foam inserts can be positioned next to the third air chamber and extend from the third air chamber to the foot end of the mattress system, over the second air chamber and the foam inserts. In some embodiments, instead of stacking foam inserts, foam inserts of greater height can be positioned in mattress system where air chambers are not stacked.

(9) In some embodiments, the mattress system can have two sections (e.g., left and right sections) to accommodate two users on the bed. Each of the sections can include a set of air chambers, which can be stacked as described herein, and one or more foam inserts. Pressure can then be adjusted for each section based on preferences of each of the two users.

(10) Particular embodiments described herein include a mattress having a first air chamber, a second air chamber stacked beneath the first air chamber that is fluidly connected to the first air chamber, and a support stacked beneath the first air chamber and positioned between the second air chamber and a foot end of the mattress.

(11) In some implementations, the mattress can optionally include one or more of the following features. For example, the mattress can also include a foam layer positioned at a top surface of the mattress above the first air chamber. The first air chamber can extend across a length of the mattress from a head end to the foot end of the mattress. Moreover, the second air chamber can be positioned at a shoulder region of the mattress.

(12) As another example, the first air chamber and the second air chamber can have a common internal pressure. Decreasing the common internal pressure in the first air chamber and the second air chamber can cause the support stacked beneath the first air chamber and positioned between the second air chamber and the foot end of the mattress to increase support at a lumbar region of the mattress.

(13) Sometimes, one or more additional supports can be positioned beneath the first air chamber and between at least one of (i) the second air chamber and a head end of the mattress, (ii) the second air chamber and the support, and (iii) the support and the foot end of the mattress. The mattress can sometimes include a third air chamber stacked beneath the first air chamber and positioned between the support and the foot end of the mattress, such that the third air chamber can be positioned at a hip region of the mattress. An additional support can also be positioned beneath the second air chamber and the support and configured to extend across a length of a bottom surface of the mattress.

(14) As another example, the mattress can include a foam rail structure including a head portion, a foot portion, and first and second side portions, the foam rail structure stacked beneath the first air chamber and configured to extend around a perimeter of the mattress to surround the second air chamber and the support. The second air chamber can extend from a location adjacent to an inner surface of the head portion of the foam rail structure to a shoulder region of the mattress. The support can extend from a location adjacent to the second air chamber to a location adjacent to an inner surface of the foot portion of the foam rail structure.

(15) Sometimes, the support can include a foam cushion. The support can also include a rectangular open cell foam cushion positioned between the second air chamber and the foot end of the mattress at a location exterior to the second air chamber.

(16) As yet another example, the mattress can further include a first section extending longitudinally between a head end and the foot end of the mattress and extending laterally between a left side and a midline of the mattress, and a second section extending longitudinally between the head end and the foot end of the mattress and extending laterally between a right side and the midline of the mattress. The first section can include the second air chamber and the support, and the second section can include a third air chamber and a second support positioned between the

third air chamber and the foot end of the mattress. The first air chamber can extend across a top surface of the first section and the second section. Sometimes, the second air chamber and the third air chamber can have a different internal pressure. Sometimes, the support within the first section can have a first firmness level and the second support within the second section can have a second firmness level, where the first firmness level is different than the second firmness level.

(17) As another example, the mattress can further include a first section extending longitudinally between a head end and the foot end of the mattress and extending laterally between a left side and a midline of the mattress, and a second section extending longitudinally between the head end and the foot end of the mattress and extending laterally between a right side and the midline of the mattress. The first section can include the first air chamber, the second air chamber, and the support, and the second section comprises a third air chamber, a fourth air chamber, and a second support positioned between the fourth air chamber and the foot end of the mattress. The first air chamber can extend across a top surface of the first section and the third air chamber can extend across a top surface of the second section. Sometimes, the first air chamber and the third air chamber can be fluidly connected to share a first common pressure and the second air chamber and the fourth air chamber can be fluidly connected to share a second common pressure. The first common pressure can be different than the second common pressure.

(18) One or more embodiments described herein include a mattress having a first air chamber, a second air chamber stacked beneath the first air chamber that is fluidly connected to the first air chamber, and a support stacked above the second air chamber and positioned between the first air chamber and a foot end of the mattress.

(19) The mattress can include any one or more of the following features. The second air chamber can extend across a length of the mattress from a head end to the foot end of the mattress. The first air chamber can be positioned at a shoulder region of the mattress. The first air chamber and the second air chamber can have a common internal pressure. Moreover, one or more additional supports can be stacked above the second air chamber and positioned between at least one of (i) the first air chamber and a head end of the mattress, (ii) the first air chamber and the support, and (iii) the support and the foot end of the mattress. The mattress may also include a third air chamber stacked above the second air chamber and positioned between the support and the foot end of the mattress. The third air chamber can be positioned at a hip region of the mattress.

(20) As another example, the mattress can also include a foam rail structure including a head portion, a foot portion, and first and second side portions, the foam rail structure configured to extend around a perimeter of the mattress. The foam rail structure can surround the first air chamber and the support. The foam rail structure can also surround the first air chamber, the second air chamber, and the support. The first air chamber can extend from a location adjacent to an inner surface of the head portion of the foam rail structure to a shoulder region of the mattress. The support can also extend from a location adjacent to the first air chamber to a location adjacent to an inner surface of the foot portion of the foam rail structure.

(21) As yet another example, the mattress can include a first section extending longitudinally between a head end and the foot end of the mattress and extending laterally between a left side and a midline of the mattress, and a second section extending longitudinally between the head end and the foot end of the mattress and extending laterally between a right side and the midline of the mattress. The first section can include the first air chamber, the second air chamber, and the support, and the second section can include a third air chamber, a fourth air chamber, and a second support positioned between the third air chamber and the foot end of the mattress. The fourth air chamber can be stacked beneath the third air chamber and the second support. Moreover, the first air chamber and the fourth air chamber can be fluidly connected to share a first common pressure and the second air chamber and the third air chamber can be fluidly connected to share a second common pressure, such that the first common pressure can be different than the second common pressure.

(22) One or more embodiments described herein can also include a mattress extending longitudinally between a head end and a foot end and extending laterally between a left side and a right side, the mattress having a first section extending longitudinally between the head end and the foot end and extending laterally between the left side and a midline of the mattress. The first section can include a first air chamber, a second air chamber stacked beneath the first air chamber, and a first support positioned between the first air chamber and the foot end of the mattress. The mattress can also have a second section extending longitudinally between the head end and the foot end and extending laterally between the right side and the midline of the mattress, the second section including a third air chamber, a fourth air chamber stacked beneath the third air chamber, and a second support positioned between the third air chamber and the foot end of the mattress.

(23) The mattress can optionally include one or more of the following features. The first air chamber can be fluidly connected to the fourth air chamber so as to have a first common internal pressure in the first and fourth air chambers, and the second air chamber can be fluidly connected to the third air chamber so as to have a second common internal pressure in the second and third air chambers. Moreover, the first common internal pressure can be different than the second common internal pressure.

(24) The mattress can also include a pump system having one or more air pumps fluidly connected to the first, second, third, and fourth air chambers. The pump system can inflate the first, second, third, and fourth air chambers. Sometimes, the mattress can include means for inflating the first, second, third, and fourth air chambers. Moreover, the mattress can include means for containing the first, second, third, and fourth air chambers, the first and second supports, and a foam layer positioned on top of each of the first, second, third, and fourth air chambers and the first and second supports.

(25) One or more embodiments described herein can include a mattress having a first air chamber positioned on a first side of the mattress, a second air chamber positioned on a second side of the mattress, a first lower air chamber positioned under the first air chamber that is fluidly connected with the second air chamber, and a second lower air chamber positioned under the second air chamber that is fluidly connected with the first air chamber.

(26) The mattress can include one or more of the following features. For example, each of the first air chamber, the second air chamber, the first lower air chamber, and the second lower air chamber can extend substantially an entire length of the mattress within a mattress cover. Each of the first air chamber, the second air chamber, the first lower air chamber, and the second lower air chamber can also have substantially the same length. Sometimes, each of the first air chamber and the second air chamber can be fluidly independent and independently adjustable. Moreover, the mattress can have a relatively level top sleep surface even when pressure is adjusted in the first air chamber and the second lower air chamber but not in the second air chamber and the first lower air chamber.

(27) One or more embodiments described herein also include a mattress having a first air chamber, and a second air chamber stacked beneath the first air chamber. The second air chamber can be fluidly connected to the first air chamber. The mattress can include any one or more of the abovementioned features.

(28) The devices, system, and techniques described herein may provide one or more of the following advantages. For example, the disclosed embodiments provide for improved spine alignment, stability, and surface continuity. For example, as air chamber pressure is uniformly decreased for all the air chambers in the mattress system, hip and shoulder regions can sink into the mattress, all while core and lumbar regions can remain supported by the foam support between the air chambers. As the air chambers deflate, the user's body can sink into the mattress more at regions of the air chambers, which can result in the foam providing more support to the user in waist/lumbar regions of the user's body. This added increased support in the waist and lumbar regions can enable an improved spine alignment for the user. Moreover, the improved spine alignment can be advantageous to improve overall sleep quality of the user. With better spine

alignment, users can experience better sleep and more comfort.

(29) As another example, some disclosed embodiments can provide for a relatively even and uniform sleep surface across a mattress system. For example, a mattress for two sleepers can have two sides. Each side can have stacked air chambers that extend substantially a length of the mattress system. A first user on a first side can adjust pressure in air chambers on the first side such that the first side is less firm. A second user on a second side can adjust pressure in air chambers on the second side such that the second side is more firm. When both sides of the mattress system are adjusted to different pressure levels, the sleep surface on top of the mattress system may be uneven. The disclosed embodiments, therefore, can provide for cross fluid connection between a top air chamber on the first side with a lower air chamber on the second side and a top air chamber on the second side with a lower air chamber on the first side. With cross fluid connection, when the air chamber on the first side is reduced in pressure for example, the lower air chamber on the second side can similarly be reduced in pressure in order to balance out the difference in pressure such that the sleep surface can be relatively even across the mattress system. Moreover, such minor adjustments in pressure to the lower air chambers may not be felt by the users. A relatively even sleep surface of the mattress system can be aesthetically pleasing and also more comfortable to users on both sides of the mattress system.

(30) As another example, some disclosed embodiments can provide for user customization of the air mattress system. The air chambers and foam inserts can be movably positioned within a rail structure of the mattress. As a result, the user can move a position or location of any of the air chambers and the foam inserts. The user can also stack air chambers or prefer not to stack air chambers. The user can also swap out any one of the air chambers and foam inserts with other air chambers and/or foam inserts. For example, the user can insert one or more foam inserts having different firmness levels. The user may desire a firmer foam insert rather than a less firm foam insert. In other words, components of the air mattress system can be interchangeable by the user with increased and/or decreased firmness depending on the user's comfort preferences. The user can also insert multiple foam inserts in one or more regions in the mattress, between one or more of the air chambers and one or both of the head end and the foot end of the mattress. As another example, the components of the air mattress system can be moved or shifted between different zones or regions of the mattress system to accommodate for different user heights and/or comfort preferences. The user can change where any of the air chambers and/or the foam insert(s) are positioned within the mattress system. For example, a taller user can move the second air chamber closer to the foot end of the mattress to accommodate for their height. A shorter user can move the second air chamber closer to the head end of the mattress (e.g. closer to the first air chamber).

(31) As another example, an air mattress system can have two sections, each with air chambers and foam insert(s) that can be customizable by two users of the bed. Therefore, when two users are sleeping in the bed, each user can adjust pressure settings for their respective air chambers. Each user can also move the air chambers and foam inserts in each of their respective sections. The disclosed embodiments can provide for each user to adjust their comfortability preferences independent of the other user.

(32) As another example, the air chambers can be a same size, which can be cost effective in manufacturing and production of the air mattress system. The user can also replace or swap out one or more of the air chambers with differently sized chambers. Doing so can accommodate to the user's comfort preferences. For example, the user can swap out an air chamber with a longer air chamber that extends from the hip region to the foot end of the mattress.

(33) In embodiments where two (or more) air chambers are fluidly connected, a single pressure setting can be used when adjusting firmness of the mattress, which can provide a relatively simple system for a user to adjust mattress firmness. Using a single pressure setting can also provide for consistent spinal alignment (as opposed to allowing different pressure settings in each chamber which can result in one chamber being undesirably firm as compared to another chamber).

Therefore, parts of the user's body can be balanced across the top surface of the mattress system. Moreover, fluid connection of the air chambers can provide for less costly manufacturing and greater ease in maintenance or fixing components of the system as described herein.

(34) The details of one or more implementations are set forth in the accompanying drawings and the description below. Other features and advantages will be apparent from the description and drawings, and from the claims.

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## Description

### BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

- (1) FIG. 1 is an example mattress system as described herein.
- (2) FIG. 2 depicts components of the mattress system described herein.
- (3) FIG. 3 is an example configuration of components of the mattress system.
- (4) FIG. 4 is another example configuration of components of the mattress system.
- (5) FIG. 5 is another example configuration of components of the mattress system.
- (6) FIG. 6 is another example configuration of components of the mattress system.
- (7) FIGS. 7A-H depict example configurations of the mattress system having stacked air chambers.
- (8) FIG. 8 depicts the example mattress system with a pump.
- (9) FIG. 9 is a block diagram of an example of various components of the mattress system with the pump.
- (10) FIG. 10A is a cross sectional side view of another example configuration of components of a mattress system.
- (11) FIG. 10B is a cross section head end view of the example configuration of components of the mattress system in FIG. 10A.

(12) Like reference symbols in the various drawings indicate like elements.

### DETAILED DESCRIPTION OF ILLUSTRATIVE EMBODIMENTS

(13) This document generally relates to air mattress systems with foam or other suitable support and a plurality of air chambers that can be positioned and stacked in such a way to provide support and sleeper spine alignment through a range of firmness pressure settings.

(14) Referring to the figures, FIG. 1 is an example mattress system **100** as described herein. The mattress system **100** is depicted upside down to show components contained therein. The mattress system **100** can include a rail structure **110**, a first air chamber **102A**, a second air chamber **102B**, a first foam insert **104A**, a second foam insert **104B**, a third air chamber **106A**, a fourth air chamber **106B**, a third foam insert **108A**, and a fourth foam insert **108B**. The first and second air chambers **102A** and **102B** and the first and second foam inserts **104A** and **104B** can be part of a first section of the mattress **100** that extends longitudinally between a head end **114** and a foot end **116** of the mattress system **100** and extends laterally between a right side and a midline of the mattress system **100**. The third and fourth air chambers **106A** and **106B** and the third and fourth foam inserts **108A** and **108B** can be part of a second section of the mattress system **100** that extends longitudinally between the head end **114** and the foot end **116** of the mattress system **100** and extends laterally between a left side and the midline of the mattress system **100**, as depicted in FIG. 1.

(15) The rail structure **110** can be a foam structure positioned around a perimeter of the mattress system **100**. The rail structure **110** can provide some shape and/or structural support to the mattress system **100**. In some implementations, one or more additional foam layers can be inserted between the rail structure **110** and one or more of the chambers **102A** and **106A** at the head end **114** of the mattress system **100**, as depicted and described further in reference to FIG. 6. The additional foam layers can be advantageous to help with positioning the chambers **102A** and **106A** farther away from the head end **114** of the mattress system **100**. Such a configuration can be preferred by a user who is shorter in height in comparison to a taller user.

(16) In some implementations, air chambers can be stacked inside the mattress system **100**. For example, in a shoulder region of the mattress system **100**, an additional, lower air chamber (e.g., refer to lower air chamber **1000A** in FIG. **10A**) can be stacked or positioned beneath the first air chamber **102A** and fluidly connected to the first and second air chambers **102A** and **102B**. One or more other stacking configurations can be realized for the mattress system **100**, as described further in relation to FIGS. **7A-H**.

(17) The first, second, third, and/or fourth foam inserts **104A**, **104B**, **108A**, and **108B**, respectively, can be made of foam or some similar type of cushioning material, such as synthetic support materials (e.g., polymer materials) or natural support materials. In some implementations, all the foam inserts **104A**, **104B**, **108A**, and **108B** can have a same firmness level. Any one or more of the foam inserts **104A**, **104B**, **108A**, and **108B** can also have different firmness levels, based on user preference or as otherwise suitable for the application. For example, foam inserts that are positioned around the lumbar region of the mattress system **100** can be more firm than foam inserts positioned around the foot region of the mattress system **100**. Any one or more of the foam inserts **104A**, **104B**, **108A**, and/or **108B** can also include a rectangular open cell foam cushion. Such a foam cushion can, for example, be positioned between the first and second air chambers **102A** and **102B** and/or the third and fourth air chambers **106A** and **106B** at a location exterior to both sets of chambers **102A** and **102B** and **106A** and **106B**. As depicted throughout the disclosure, the foam inserts **104A**, **104B**, **108A**, and **108B** can be positioned between the first and second air chambers **102A** and **102B** and the third and fourth air chambers **106A** and **106B**, respectively, so as to physically separate the first air chamber **102A** from the second air chamber **102B** longitudinally and the third air chamber **106A** from the fourth air chamber **106B** longitudinally. One or more of the foam inserts **104A**, **104B**, **108A**, and **108B** can have different or same firmness levels based on user preference.

(18) One or more of the first, second, third, and fourth foam inserts **104A**, **104B**, **108A**, and **108B** can be insertable and moveable inside the rail structure **110**. Therefore, any one or more of the foam inserts **104A**, **104B**, **108A**, and **108B** can be replaced, switched with other supports, and otherwise moved to different regions or locations within the mattress system **100** as desired by the user. In some implementations, one or more of the foam inserts **104A**, **104B**, **108A**, and **108B** can be attached to the rail structure **110**. For example, one or more of the foam inserts **104A**, **104B**, **108A**, and **108B** can be attached to a rail structure **110** using laminate, glue, adhesives, buttons, snaps, hook-and-loop fasteners, and/or zippers. In some implementations, one or more of the foam inserts **104A**, **104B**, **108A**, and **108B** can removably attach to the rail structure **110** to retain it in place but also to provide customization of component arrangement within the mattress system **100**.

(19) The mattress system **100** can be sized in a number of suitable mattress sizes, including Full, Queen, and King sized beds. In some of such implementations, the mattress system **100** can include a first zone having the first air chamber **102A**, the second air chamber **102B**, the first foam insert **104A**, and the second foam insert **104B**. The mattress system **100** can also include a second zone having the third air chamber **106A**, the fourth air chamber **106B**, the third foam insert **108A**, and the fourth foam insert **108B**. The first zone can be used by a first user and the second zone can be used by a second user. In some implementations, such as with Full, Twin, or Single beds, the mattress system **100** may only include the first air chamber **102A**, the second air chamber **102B**, the first foam insert **104A**, and the second foam insert **104B**. The second air chamber **102B** can be fluidly connected to the first air chamber **102A**. Similarly, the fourth air chamber **106B** can be fluidly connected to the third air chamber **106A** in the mattress system **100** that is Full, Queen, and/or King sized. As a result, a single zone air pressure (e.g., common internal pressure) can be maintained between the first and second air chambers **102A** and **102B** and the third and fourth air chambers **106A** and **106B**, respectively. Maintaining the single zone air pressure can be advantageous to make controlling adjustability settings of the mattress system **100** easier for a user or users. Moreover, maintaining single zone air pressures can reduce manufacturing costs of the

mattress system **100**. For example, all air chambers can be produced in a same size having same pressure settings and adjustability features. As a result, if air chambers need to be fixed, swapped out, or otherwise replaced, maintenance costs can be lower and more affordable. Fixing any of the air chambers used in the mattress system **100** can be easier and faster.

(20) Maintaining a single air pressure between the first and second air chambers **102A** and **102B** and the third and fourth air chambers **106A** and **106B** can further provide spine alignment and lumbar support. Therefore, when air pressure is adjusted, portions of the user's body can be aligned relatively well both before and after the pressure adjustment. As pressure is uniformly decreased from the first and second air chambers **102A** and **102B**, the foam inserts **104A** and **104B** will not deflate with the chambers **102A** and **102B**. Therefore, the foam inserts **104A** and **104B** provide continuous support to waist, and/or lower leg regions to maintain or even improve spine alignment and overall comfortability, even when the user desires to lower pressure levels of the chambers **102A** and **102B** in the mattress system **100**. Therefore, decreasing the common internal pressure in the first and second air chambers **102A** and **102B** can cause the foam insert **104A** positioned between the chambers **102A** and **102B** to maintain or even increase support at the lumbar region of the mattress system **100**.

(21) As shown in FIG. 1, the first and third air chambers **102A** and **106A** can be positioned at the shoulder region of the mattress system **100** and the second and fourth air chambers **102B** and **106B** can be positioned at the hip region of the mattress system **100**. One or more other configurations can be realized based on user preference and as described throughout this disclosure. The first air chamber **102A** can be positioned at a head end **114** of the mattress system **100** around a shoulder region. The first foam insert **104A** can be positioned between the first air chamber **102A** and the second air chamber **102B** and the second foam insert **104B** can be positioned between the second air chamber **102B** and a foot end **116** of the mattress system **100**. The third air chamber **106A**, the fourth air chamber **106B**, the third foam insert **108A**, and the fourth foam insert **108B** are similarly positioned. Any one or more of the components can also be arranged in different configurations, as described throughout this disclosure (e.g., refer to FIGS. 3-6). Furthermore, one or more of the components, such as the first, second, third, and fourth foam inserts **104A**, **104B**, **108A**, and **108B**, respectively, can be removed and/or replaced based on user preference. In some implementations, one or more additional foam inserts can be positioned between at least one of the first air chamber **102A** and the head end **114** of the mattress system **100**, the first air chamber **102A** and the second air chamber **102B**, and the second air chamber **102B** and the foot end **116** of the mattress system **100** (e.g., refer to FIGS. 3-6).

(22) Moreover, as depicted, the components of the mattress system **100** are arranged inside a perimeter formed by the rail structure **110**. The rail structure **110** can be a foam structure (or other material suitable for the application) that can maintain the components described herein in place when the mattress system **100** is moved and used. The rail structure **110** can therefore be positioned around a perimeter of the mattress system **100**.

(23) The mattress can also include a mattress cover **112**. The mattress cover **112** can cover the components described herein to also maintain the components in place. The mattress cover **112** can be made of one or more fabrics or other similar textile materials. The mattress cover **112** can enclose the entire mattress system **100**. The mattress cover **112** can also contain one or more foam layers (not shown in FIG. 1) that can be positioned on top of each of the first, second, third, and fourth air chambers **102A**, **102B**, **106A**, and **106B**, respectively, as well as the first, second, third, and fourth foam inserts **104A**, **104B**, **108A**, and **108B**, respectively.

(24) As depicted in FIGS. 8-9, the mattress system **100** can be in fluid communication (via hoses) to a pump **720**. The pump **720** can include one or more air pumps that can be fluidly connected to the first, second, third, and fourth air chambers **102A**, **102B**, **106A**, and **106B**, respectively. The pump **720** can be configured to inflate the first and second air chambers **102A** and **102B** to a first common internal pressure. The pump **720** can also be configured to inflate the third and fourth air

chambers **106A** and **106B** to a second common internal pressure. The first common internal pressure can be different than the second common internal pressure, for example, based on user preference.

(25) FIG. 2 depicts the mattress system **100** positioned upside down with a bottom portion of the cover **112** open to show various internal components of the mattress system **100**. The mattress system **100** can include a layer **118** positioned between a top surface of the mattress system **100** and each of the first, second, third, and fourth air chambers **102A**, **102B**, **106A**, and **106B** as well as the rail structure **110**, and the first, second, third, and fourth foam inserts **104A**, **104B**, **108A**, and **108B**. The layer **118** can be made of foam or another similar material or cushion. For example, the layer **118** can be formed of one or more viscoelastic foam materials or other materials suitable for the application. The layer **118** can provide comfort to the user when sleeping in the mattress system **100**. In some embodiments, the layer **118** can be adhered or otherwise attached to the rail structure **110** to form somewhat of a foam tub. The foam tub (formed by a combination of the layer **118** and the rail structure **110**) is, effectively, an upside-down foam tub when the mattress system **100** is flipped right-side-up.

(26) FIG. 3 is an example configuration of components of the mattress system **100**. FIGS. 4, 5, and 6 are additional example configurations of components of the mattress system **100**. The FIGS. 3-6 depict different air chamber and/or foam insert orientations and placements within the mattress **100**. As shown in the FIGS. 3-6, the foam inserts can be interchangeable, removed, and/or replaced with other types and/or sizes of foam inserts. One or more users of the mattress system **100** can customize positioning of the components depicted and described throughout this disclosure. For example, a tall user can prefer to position the second air chamber **102B** closer to a foot end of the mattress **100** to accommodate for their height. A shorter user can prefer to position the first and second air chambers **102A** and **102B** closer together to accommodate for their height. As another example, a user can prefer to position multiple firmer foam inserts between the first and second air chambers **102A** and **102B** to provide more support to their lumbar region.

(27) The air chambers **102A**, **102B**, **106A**, and **106B** can be the same size (or substantially the same size) as each other. This can be advantageous for simplicity and also lower cost for manufacturing, repair, and/or replacement, as well as for maintaining all portions of the body balanced and aligned while the pressure settings of the mattress system **100** change. In some implementations, as shown in FIG. 4, one or more of the air chambers **102A**, **102B**, **106A**, and **106B** can be different sizes. For example, the second and fourth air chambers **102B** and **106B** can be longer than the first and third air chambers **102A** and **106A** (e.g., refer to FIG. 4). In some implementations, the first and second air chambers **102A** and **102B** can be first sizes and the third and fourth air chambers **104A** and **104B** can be second sizes, based on user preference. The first and second sizes can be different.

(28) Referring to the FIGS. 3-6, the rail structure **110** can include a head portion **120**, a foot portion **122**, and first and second side portions **124** and **126**. The rail structure **110** can extend around a perimeter of the mattress system **100** to surround the first, second, third, and fourth air chambers **102A**, **102B**, **106A**, and **106B**, respectively, as well as the foam inserts as described herein (e.g., foam inserts **104A-C** and **108A-C** in FIG. 3; **104A**, **104C**, **108A**, and **108C** in FIG. 4; **104A-N** and **108A-N** in FIGS. 5-6). In some implementations, as shown in FIG. 4, the second and fourth air chambers **102B** and **106B** can extend from a hip region of the mattress system **100** to a location adjacent to an inner surface of the foot portion **122** of the foam rail structure **110**. Similarly, the first air chamber **102A** can extend from a location adjacent to an inner surface of the head portion **120** of the foam rail structure to a shoulder region of the mattress system **100**.

(29) In some implementations, such as where the mattress system **100** has only the first and second air chambers **102A** and **102B**, the first air chamber **102A** can be positioned at the shoulder region of the mattress system **100** and extend laterally between locations adjacent to inner surfaces of the first and second side portions **124** and **126** of the rail structure **110**. The second air chamber **102B**

can be positioned at the hip region of the mattress system **100** and extend laterally between the locations adjacent to the inner surfaces of the first and second side portions **124** and **126** of the rail structure **110**.

(30) As depicted in FIGS. 3-6, one or more foam inserts can be positioned between the first and third air chambers **102A** and **106A** and a location adjacent to an inner surface of the head portion **120** of the rail structure **110** and extend laterally between locations adjacent to inner surfaces of the first and second side portions **124** and **126** of the rail structure **110** and a midline of the mattress system **100**. As depicted in FIGS. 3, 5, and 6, one or more foam inserts can be positioned between the second and fourth air chambers **104B** and **108B** at a location adjacent to an inner surface of the foot portion **122** of the rail structure **110** and extend laterally between the locations adjacent to the inner surfaces of the first and second side portions **124** and **126** of the rail structure **110** and the midline of the mattress system **100**.

(31) FIG. 3 depicts a configuration in which foam inserts **104C** and **108C** are positioned between the head portion **120** of the rail structure **110** and the first and third air chambers **102A** and **106A**, respectively. Foam inserts **104A** and **108A** can be positioned between the first and third air chambers **102A** and **106A** and the second and fourth air chambers **102B** and **106B**, respectively. Foam inserts **104B** and **108B** can be positioned between the second and fourth air chambers **102B** and **106B** and the foot portion **122** of the rail structure **110**. In some implementations, the components **102A**, **102B**, **104A**, **104B**, and **104C** can be arranged differently than the components **106A**, **106B**, **108A**, **108B**, and **108C**, based on user preferences.

(32) FIG. 4 is another example configuration of components of the mattress system **100**. As shown and described throughout, the second and fourth air chambers **102B** and **106B** can extend from the waist region of the mattress to the foot portion **122** of the rail structure **110**. Moreover, as described throughout, a first user can set up the air chambers **102A** and **102B** as depicted in FIG. 4 and a second user can set up the air chambers **106A** and **106B** as depicted in any of the other configurations described herein.

(33) FIG. 5 is another example configuration of components of the mattress system **100**. One or more users can position multiple foam inserts **104C-N** and **108C-N** between the first and second air chambers **102A** and **102B** and the third and fourth air chambers **106A** and **106B**, respectively. Foam inserts **104C-N** and **108C-N** can be relatively short to allow a user to move or remove one or more of them while leaving the others in place, thus adjusting the mattress as appropriate for a given user.

(34) FIG. 6 is another example configuration of components of the mattress system **100**. One or more users can position one or more foam inserts **104A-B** and **108A-B** between the head portion **120** of the rail structure **110** and the first and third air chambers **102A** and **106A**, respectively. One or more users can additionally or alternatively position one or more foam inserts **104D-N** and **108D-N** between the first and second air chambers **102A** and **102B** and the third and fourth air chambers **106A** and **106B**, respectively.

(35) FIGS. 7A-H depict example configurations of the mattress system having stacked air chambers. FIG. 7A is a schematic side view of mattress system **700A** with a cover removed to show internal components thereof. The configuration in FIG. 7A is advantageous to provide additional support and adjustment in a shoulder region of the mattress system **700A**. The mattress system **700A** has a head end **712** and a foot end **714**. The mattress system **700A** can include a top layer **710**, an air chamber **704**, a rail structure **702**, an air chamber **706A**, foam inserts **708A** and **708B**, and a foam base layer **716**. A mattress cover (not shown in FIG. 7A) can be positioned on an outside of the mattress system **700A**. The top layer **710** can extend across an entire length of the mattress system **700A** from the head end **712** to the foot end **714** of the mattress system **700**. The top layer **710** can be any type of material as described throughout this disclosure, such as foam, batting, or other suitable material. The top layer **710** can provide comfort and/or support to a user resting on the mattress system **700A**.

(36) The air chamber **704** can extend across some, most, or all of a length of the mattress system **700A** from the head end **712** to the foot end **714** of the mattress system **700A**. In the embodiment illustrated in FIG. 7A, the air chamber **704** extends substantially an entire length of the mattress system **700A** except for a cover (not shown) positioned on the outside. The air chamber **706A** and the foam inserts **708A** and **708B** can be stacked beneath the air chamber **704**. For example, as depicted in FIG. 7A, the air chamber **706A** can be closer to the head end **712** of the mattress system **700A** to provide additional and improved adjustment in a shoulder and head region of the mattress system **700A**. The foam inserts **708A** and **708B** can be positioned next to each other along the length of the mattress system **700A** from the air chamber **706A** to the foot end **714** of the mattress system **700A**. The foam base layer **716** can, like the air chamber **704**, extend across the entire length of the mattress system **700A** from the head end **712** to the foot end **714**, beneath the air chamber **704**, the stacked air chamber **706A**, and the foam inserts **708A** and **708B**.

(37) The rail structure **702** can form a perimeter around the stacked air chamber **706A**, the foam inserts **708A** and **708B**, and the foam base layer **716**. The rail structure **702** can provide additional structural support to the mattress system **700** and maintain the stacked air chamber **706A**, the foam inserts **708A** and **708B**, and the foam base layer **716** in place.

(38) One or more of the components described in reference to the mattress system **700A** in FIG. 7A can be similar and/or same as the components described throughout this disclosure (e.g., refer to FIG. 1). Moreover, in some implementations, the air chambers **704** and **706A** can be fluidly connected to share a common pressure. This configuration is advantageous to provide increased support, spinal alignment, and adjustment in the shoulder region of the mattress system **700A**. In some implementations, the air chambers **704** and **706A** can have different pressures to provide for increased customization of support by the user.

(39) In operation, pressure can be adjusted concurrently in the air chambers **704** and **706A**. As pressure is increased, for example, in the air chambers **704** and **706A**, the user can experience increased support and/or firmness in the shoulder region. As pressure is decreased in the air chambers **704** and **706A**, the mattress **700A** can provide an increasingly soft (less firm) mattress across a user's entire body because pressure decreases in air chamber **704**. Further, this can allow the user's body to sink in at the shoulder region more than at the legs and hips because pressure also decreases in the air chamber **706A** without substantially changing the firmness of the foam inserts **708A** and **708B**. Thus, reducing pressure in the air chambers **704** and **706A** can allow a user to sink in more at the shoulder region than at other regions to reduce pressure while also maintaining spinal alignment of the user.

(40) FIG. 7B is a schematic side view of mattress system **700B** with a cover removed to show internal components thereof. The configuration in FIG. 7B is advantageous to provide additional support and adjustment in the shoulder region and a hip region of the mattress system **700B**. The mattress system **700B** can include the top layer **710**, the rail structure **702**, a first air chamber **706A**, a second air chamber **706B**, foam inserts **708A** and **708B**, the air chamber **704**, and the foam base layer **716**. A mattress cover (not shown in FIG. 7B) can be positioned on an outside of the mattress system **700B**. In the illustrated embodiment, the top layer **710** extends between head and foot portions of the rail structures **702**. In alternative embodiments, such as described in reference to FIG. 7A, the top layer **710** can extend across substantially the entire length of the mattress system **700B** from the head end **712** to the foot end **714** of the mattress system **700B**.

(41) The first air chamber **706A** can be positioned in the shoulder region of the mattress system **700B**, at the head end **712** of the mattress system **700B**. The foam insert **708A** can be positioned between the first air chamber **706A** and the second air chamber **706B**. The second air chamber **706B** can be positioned in the hip region of the mattress system **700B**. The foam insert **708B** can extend from the second air chamber **706B** to the foot end of the mattress system **700B** across a leg region of the mattress system **700B**.

(42) The air chamber **704** can extend across some, most, or all of a length of the mattress system

**700B** from the head end **712** to the foot end **714** beneath the top layer **710**, the first and second air chambers **706A** and **706B**, and the foam inserts **708A** and **708B**. In the embodiment illustrated in FIG. 7B, the air chamber **704** extends substantially an entire length of the mattress system **700B**, except for a cover (not shown) positioned on the outside. The foam base layer **716** can, like the air chamber **704**, extend across some, most, or all of a length of the mattress system **700B** from the head end **712** to the foot end **714**, and be positioned beneath the air chamber **704**.

(43) The rail structure **702** can form a perimeter around the top layer **710**, the first and second air chambers **706A** and **706B**, the foam inserts **708A** and **708B**, the air chamber **704**, and the foam base layer **716**. The rail structure **702** can provide additional structural support to the mattress system **700B** and maintain the components described herein in place.

(44) One or more of the components described in reference to the mattress system **700B** in FIG. 7B can be similar and/or same as the components described throughout this disclosure (e.g., refer to FIG. 1). Moreover, in some implementations, the air chambers **704**, **706A**, and **706B** can be fluidly connected to share a common pressure. This configuration is advantageous to provide increased support, spinal alignment, and adjustment in the shoulder and hip regions of the mattress system **700B**. In some implementations, the air chambers **704**, **706A**, and **706B** can have different pressures to provide for increased customization of support by the user.

(45) In operation, pressure can be adjusted concurrently in the air chambers **704**, **706A**, and **706B**. As pressure is increased, for example, the user can experience increased support and/or firmness in the shoulder and hip regions. As pressure is decreased in the air chambers **704**, **706A**, and **706B**, the mattress **700A** can provide an increasingly soft mattress across a user's entire body because pressure decreases in air chamber **704**, and further, can allow the user's body to sink in at the shoulder region and hip region more than at the legs and waist because pressure also decreases in the air chamber **706A** (shoulders) and the air chamber **706B** (hips) without substantially changing the firmness of the foam inserts **708A** (legs) and **708B** (waist). Thus, reducing pressure in the air chambers **704**, **706A**, and **706B** can allow a user to sink in more at the shoulder and hips regions than at other regions to reduce pressure while also maintaining spinal alignment of the user.

(46) FIG. 7C is a schematic side view of mattress system **700C** with a cover removed to show internal components thereof. The mattress system **700C** is advantageous because it enables more direct firmness adjustments to be made for all regions of a sleeper's body while still focusing a largest amount of adjustment in a region where air chambers are stacked. Thus, the mattress system **700C** can maintain and improve spinal alignment as well as comfortability for the entire body of the sleeper. The configuration in FIG. 7C is also advantageous to provide additional support and adjustment in the shoulder region of the mattress system **700C** and to reduce a number of components used in the mattress system **700C**. Fewer components can make maintenance of the mattress system **700C** easier, faster, and less costly. Fewer components can also make it easier for the user to replace or otherwise swap out one or more of the components.

(47) Referring to the mattress system **700C** in FIG. 7C, the mattress system **700C** can include the top layer **710**, the rail structure **702**, the air chamber **704**, the air chamber **706A**, the foam insert **708A**, and the foam base layer **716**. In the illustrated embodiment, the top layer **710** extends between head and foot portions of the rail structures **702**. In alternative embodiments, such as described in reference to FIG. 7A, the top layer **710** can extend across substantially the entire length of the mattress system **700C** from the head end **712** to the foot end **714** of the mattress system **700**. The air chamber **704** can extend beneath the top layer **710** across some, most, or all of a length of the mattress system **700C** from the head end **712** to the foot end **714** of the mattress system **700C**. The air chamber **706A** can be positioned in the shoulder region of the mattress system **700C**, at the head end **712** of the mattress system **700C**. The foam insert **708A** can be positioned next to the air chamber **706A** and can extend from the air chamber **706A** to the foot end **714** of the mattress system **700**. In this configuration, only one foam insert is used in the mattress system **700C**. This can be advantageous for the reasons mentioned above. The foam base layer **716**

can, like the air chamber **704**, extend across some, most, or all of a length of the mattress system **700C** from the head end **712** to the foot end **714**, and be positioned beneath the top layer **710**, the air chamber **704**, the stacked air chamber **706A**, and the foam insert **708A**.

(48) The rail structure **702** can form a perimeter around the top layer **710**, the air chamber **704**, the stacked air chamber **706A**, the foam insert **708A**, and the foam base layer **716**. The rail structure **702** can provide additional structural support to the mattress system **700** and maintain the components described herein in place.

(49) One or more of the components described in reference to the mattress system **700C** in FIG. 7C can be similar and/or same as the components described throughout this disclosure (e.g., refer to FIG. 1). Moreover, in some implementations, the air chambers **704** and **706A** can be fluidly connected to share a common pressure. This configuration is advantageous to provide increased support, spinal alignment, and adjustment in the shoulder region of the mattress system **700C**. In some implementations, the air chambers **704** and **706A** can have different pressures to provide for increased customization of support by the user.

(50) In operation, pressure can be adjusted concurrently in the air chambers **704** and **706A**. As pressure is increased, for example, in the air chambers **704** and **706A**, the user can experience increased support and/or firmness. As pressure is decreased in the air chambers **704** and **706A**, the mattress **700A** can provide an increasingly soft (less firm) mattress across a user's entire body because pressure decreases in air chamber **704**, and further, can allow the user's body to sink in at the shoulder region more than at the legs and hips because pressure also decreases in the air chamber **706A** without substantially changing the firmness of the foam insert **708A**. Thus, reducing pressure in the air chambers **704** and **706A** can allow a user to sink in more at the shoulder region than at other regions to reduce pressure while also maintaining spinal alignment of the user.

(51) FIG. 7D is a schematic side view of mattress system **700D** with a cover removed to show internal components thereof. The mattress system **700D** is similar to the mattress system **700C** of FIG. 7C, except that the air chamber **704** is positioned below the air chamber **706A** and the foam insert **708A** in the mattress system **700D**, and the air chamber **704** is positioned above the air chamber **706A** and the foam insert **708A** in the mattress system **700C**. Accordingly, the mattress system **700D** can function similarly to the mattress system **700C** in many ways, as described above. In some embodiments, the mattress system **700D** differs from the mattress system **700C** in that the mattress system **700D** can provide more focus on adjusting a shoulder region of the mattress system **700D** rather than adjusting regions for all regions of the body.

(52) FIG. 7E is a schematic side view of mattress system **700E** with a cover removed to show internal components thereof. The configuration in FIG. 7E is advantageous to provide additional and customizable support and adjustment across the entire length of the mattress system **700E**. Referring to the mattress system **700E** in FIG. 7E, the mattress system **700E** can include the foam insert **708A**, the first air chamber **706A**, the second air chamber **706B**, the air chamber **704**, and the foam insert **708B**. The foam insert **708A** can extend across some, most, or all of a length of the mattress system **700E** from the head end **712** to the foot end **714**, similar to the top layer **710** described in FIGS. 7A-D.

(53) The first and second air chambers **706A** and **706B** can be positioned beneath the foam insert **708A**. The first air chamber **706A** can be positioned in the shoulder region of the mattress system **700** and can extend to the head end **712** of the mattress system **700E**. The second air chamber **706B** can extend from the first air chamber **706A** to the foot end **714** of the mattress system **700E**. The second air chamber **706B** can therefore be positioned in the lumbar/hip/waist/leg region of the mattress system **700E**.

(54) The air chamber **704** can be stacked beneath the foam insert **708A** and the first and second air chambers **706A** and **706B**, and can extend across some, most, or all of a length of the mattress system **700E**, from the head end **712** to the foot end **714**. In the example of FIG. 7E, the air chamber **704** extends substantially an entire length of the mattress system **700E**. Moreover, the air

chamber **704** is taller in height than the first and second air chambers **706A** and **706B**. In some implementations, the air chambers **704**, **706A**, and **706B** can have a same or similar height. In yet other implementations, the first and second air chambers **706A** and **706B** can be taller in height than the air chamber **704**. A taller height of the first air chamber **706A** can be advantageous to enable more directed spinal alignment focus. The foam insert **708B** can be positioned and stacked beneath the air chamber **704**, and can extend across some, most, or all of a length of the mattress system **700E**, from the head end **712** to the foot end **714**, like the air chamber **704**. The foam insert **708B** can be similar to the foam base layer **716** described in reference to FIGS. 7A-D.

(55) In the example configuration of FIG. 7E, the first air chamber **706A** and the stacked air chamber **704** are in fluid communication **720**. Therefore, the first air chamber **706A** and the stacked air chamber **704** can share a common pressure and can be adjusted together to improve and increase support in the shoulder region of the mattress system **700E**. The second air chamber **706B** may not be fluidly connected to the first air chamber **706A** or the stacked air chamber **704**. The second air chamber **706B** can have a different adjustable pressure setting than the first air chamber **706A** and the stacked air chamber **704**. In some implementations, the second air chamber **706B** can be fluidly connected to the stacked air chamber **704** and the first air chamber **706A** may not be fluidly connected to either.

(56) In other implementations, the first and second air chambers **706A** and **706B** can be fluidly connected to each other but not to the stacked air chamber **704**. In other implementations, the first and second air chambers **706A** and **706B** can both be fluidly connected to the stacked air chamber **704**.

(57) One or more of the components described in reference to the mattress system **700E** in FIG. 7E can be similar and/or same as the components described throughout this disclosure (e.g., refer to FIG. 1).

(58) In operation, pressure can be adjusted concurrently in the air chambers **704** and **706A**. Pressure can be separately adjusted in the second air chamber **706B**. As pressure is increased, for example, in the air chambers **704** and **706A**, the user can experience increased support and/or firmness. As pressure is decreased in the air chambers **704** and **706A**, the mattress **700A** can provide an increasingly soft (less firm) mattress across a user's entire body because pressure decreases in air chamber **704**, and further, can allow the user's body to sink in at the shoulder region more than at the legs and hips because pressure also decreases in the air chamber **706A** without substantially changing the firmness of the air chamber **706B**. Thus, reducing pressure in the air chambers **704** and **706A** can allow a user to sink in more at the shoulder region than at other regions to reduce pressure while also maintaining spinal alignment of the user. If the user desires to adjust air pressure in the air chamber **706B**, firmness and/or spinal alignment can be further customized as appropriate for the user.

(59) FIG. 7F is a schematic side view of mattress system **700F** with a cover removed to show internal components thereof. The mattress system **700F** is similar to the mattress system **700A** of FIG. 7A, except that the mattress system **700F** does not include the foam base layer **716** that is positioned beneath the air chamber **706A** and the foam inserts **708A** and **708B** in the mattress system **700A**. Accordingly, the mattress system **700F** can function similarly to the mattress system **700A** in many ways, as described above. In some embodiments, the mattress system **700F** differs from the mattress system **700A** in that one or more of the air chambers **704** and **706A** and the foam inserts **708A** and **708B** can be taller in height in the mattress system **700F**. Moreover, having the top layer **710** in the mattress system **700F** without the foam base layer **716** can be advantageous to reduce an amount of components used in the mattress system **700F**, which can make maintenance and customization of the mattress system **700F** easier, faster, less costly, and more efficient.

(60) FIG. 7G is a schematic head end **712** view of an example configuration of components of mattress system **700G**. As shown in this view, the mattress system **700G** can include the top layer **710**, the rail structure **702**, the air chamber **706A**, and the air chamber **704**. The air chamber **704**,

like the top layer **710** described in reference to FIGS. 7A-D, can extend across some, most, or all of a length of the mattress system **700G**. The rail structure **702** can be positioned beneath the top layer **710** and can form a perimeter around the air chamber **706A**. The air chamber **706A** is positioned at the head end **712** of the mattress system **700G**. Although not depicted in the cross sectional head end **712** view of the mattress system **700G**, an additional air chamber and/or foam inserts can extend from the air chamber **706A** towards the foot end of the mattress system **700G**, as depicted in reference to FIGS. 7A-F.

(61) The air chamber **704** can be stacked beneath the top layer **710**, the rail structure **702**, and the air chamber **706A**. The stacked air chamber **704** can extend across some, most, or all of the mattress system **700G**, as described herein.

(62) The configuration in FIG. 7G can be advantageous to control a height of the rail structure **702** as well as an impact of the rail structure **702**'s height with varying pressure (e.g., firmness) settings that can be applied to the air chambers **704** and **706A**. One or more of the components described in reference to the mattress system **700G** in FIG. 7G can be similar and/or same as the components described throughout this disclosure (e.g., refer to FIG. 1). Moreover, in some implementations, the air chambers **704** and **706A** can be fluidly connected to share a common pressure. This configuration is advantageous to provide increased support, spinal alignment, and adjustment in the shoulder region of the mattress system **700G**. In some implementations, the air chambers **704** and **706A** can have different pressures to provide for increased customization of support by the user.

(63) FIG. 7H is a schematic head end view **712** of an example configuration of components of mattress system **700H**. As shown in this view, the mattress system **700H** can include the foam insert **708A**, the air chamber **704**, the rail structure **702**, and the air chamber **706A**. The foam insert **708A**, like the top layer **710** described in reference to FIGS. 7A-D, can extend across some, most, or all of a length of the mattress system **700H**. The air chamber **704** can be positioned beneath the foam insert **708A** and can extend across some, most, or all of a length of the mattress system **700H**, as described herein. The rail structure **702** can be positioned beneath the foam insert **708A** and the air chamber **704**. The rail structure **702** can form a perimeter around the air chamber **706A**. The air chamber **706A** is positioned at the head end **712** of the mattress system **700H** and stacked beneath the air chamber **704**. Although not depicted in the cross sectional head end **712** view of the mattress system **700H**, an additional air chamber and/or foam inserts can extend from the air chamber **706A** towards the foot end of the mattress system **700H**, as depicted in reference to FIGS. 7A-F.

(64) The configuration in FIG. 7H can be advantageous to control a height of the rail structure **702** as well as an impact of the rail structure **702**'s height with varying pressure (e.g., firmness) settings that can be applied to the air chambers **704** and **706A**. Moreover, one or more of the components described in reference to the mattress system **700H** in FIG. 7H can be similar and/or same as the components described throughout this disclosure (e.g., refer to FIG. 1). Moreover, in some implementations, the air chambers **704** and **706A** can be fluidly connected to share a common pressure. This configuration is advantageous to provide increased support, spinal alignment, and adjustment in the shoulder region of the mattress system **700H**. In some implementations, the air chambers **704** and **706A** can have different pressures to provide for increased customization of support by the user.

(65) It can be realized that a user can customize their mattress system using any of the configurations depicted in FIGS. 7A-H. After all, as described throughout this disclosure, the components of the mattress system **700** can be moved around and/or replaced or swapped with other components to increase customization and conform to user preferences. Therefore, the user can replace a single foam insert with multiple foam inserts, move a first air chamber closer to a lumbar region of the mattress system instead of a shoulder region, change an order for stacking components, and/or make any other changes to the configuration of the mattress system **700** as the user desires.

(66) FIG. 8 depicts the example mattress system **100** with a pump **820** and a controller **824**. The

controller **824** can be configured to operate the pump **820** to cause increases and decreases in fluid pressure of the first air chamber **102A**, the second air chamber **102B**, the third air chamber **106A**, and the fourth air chamber **106B**. In some implementations, the controller **824** is integrated into a housing of the pump **820**.

(67) FIG. **9** is a block diagram of an example of various components of the mattress system **100** with the pump **920**. As shown in FIG. **9**, the controller **824** can include a power supply **834**, one or more processors **836**, memory **837**, a switching mechanism **838**, and an analog to digital (A/D) converter **840**. The switching mechanism **838** can be, for example, a relay or a solid state switch. In some implementations, the switching mechanism **838** can be located in the pump **820** rather than the controller **824**. The controller **824** can be in wired or wireless communication with the pump **820**.

(68) The pump **820** can include a motor **942**, a pump manifold **843**, a relief valve **844**, a first control valve **845A**, a second control valve **845B**, and one or more pressure transducers **846**. The pump **820** is fluidly connected with the first air chamber **102A** via a first tube **848A** and the third air chamber **106A** via a second tube **848B**. The first air chamber **102A** can then be fluidly connected with the second air chamber **102B** via a third tube **848D**. The third air chamber **106A** can be fluidly connected with the fourth air chamber **106B** via a fourth tube **848C**. The first and second control valves **845A** and **845B** can be controlled by the switching mechanism **838**, and are operable to regulate the flow of fluid between the pump **820** and the first air chamber **102A** and also between the pump **820** the third air chamber **106A**. The tube **848D** can fluidly connect the air chamber **102A** to the air chamber **102B** so that the pressure in the air chamber **102B** is the same or substantially the same as the air pressure in the air chamber **102A**. Accordingly, the pump **820** can adjust air pressure in air chambers **102A** and **102B** at substantially the same time to substantially the same pressure. The tube **848C** can fluidly connect the air chamber **106A** to the air chamber **106B** so that the pressure in the air chamber **106B** is the same or substantially the same as the air pressure in the air chamber **106A**. Accordingly, the pump **820** can adjust air pressure in air chambers **106A** and **106B** at substantially the same time to substantially the same pressure.

(69) In some implementations, the pump **820** and the controller **824** can be provided and packaged as a single unit. In some alternative implementations, the pump **820** and the controller **824** can be provided as physically separate units. In some implementations, the controller **824**, the pump **820**, or both are integrated within or otherwise contained within a bed frame or bed support structure that supports the mattress system **100**. In some implementations, the controller **824**, the pump **820**, or both are located outside of a bed frame or bed support structure.

(70) In some implementations, a separate pump can be associated with each air chamber of the air bed system or a pump can be associated with multiple chambers of the air bed system. Separate pumps can allow each air chamber to be inflated or deflated independently and simultaneously. Furthermore, additional pressure transducers can also be incorporated into the air bed system such that, for example, a separate pressure transducer can be associated with each air chamber.

(71) In use, the processor **836** can, for example, send a decrease pressure command to one of the air chambers **102A** and **102B** and/or **106A** and **106B**, and the switching mechanism **838** can be used to convert the low voltage command signals sent by the processor **836** to higher operating voltages sufficient to operate the relief valve **844** of the pump **820** and open the control valve **845A** or **845B**. Opening the relief valve **844** can allow air to escape from the air chambers **102A** and **102B** via the respective air tubes **848A** and **848D**. Opening the relief valve **844** can also allow air to escape from the air chambers **106A** and **106B** via the respective air tubes **848B** and **848C**. During deflation, the pressure transducer **846** can send pressure readings to the processor **836** via the A/D converter **840**. The A/D converter **840** can receive analog information from pressure transducer **846** and can convert the analog information to digital information useable by the processor **836**.

(72) As another example, the processor **836** can send an increase pressure command. The pump motor **942** can be energized in response to the increase pressure command and send air to the

designated air chambers **102A** and **102B** and/or **106A** and **106B** through the respective tubes **848A** and **848D** and/or **848B** and **848C** via electronically operating the corresponding valve **845B** or **845A**. While air is being delivered to the designated air chambers **102A** and **102B** and/or **106A** and **106B** to increase the firmness of the chambers, the pressure transducer **846** can sense pressure within the pump manifold **843**. Again, the pressure transducer **846** can send pressure readings to the processor **836** via the A/D converter **840**. The processor **836** can use the information received from the A/D converter **840** to determine the difference between the actual pressure in the air chambers **102A** and **102B** and/or **106A** and **106B** and the desired pressure.

(73) Generally speaking, during an inflation or deflation process, the pressure sensed within the pump manifold **843** can provide an approximation of the pressure within the respective air chamber that is in fluid communication with the pump manifold **843**. An example method of obtaining a pump manifold pressure reading that is substantially equivalent to the actual pressure within an air chamber includes turning off pump **820**, allowing the pressure within the air chambers **102A** and **102B** and/or **106A** and **106B** and the pump manifold **843** to equalize, and then sensing the pressure within the pump manifold **843** with the pressure transducer **846**. Thus, providing a sufficient amount of time to allow the pressures within the pump manifold **843** and air chambers **102A** and **102B** and/or **106A** and **106B** to equalize can result in pressure readings that are accurate approximations of the actual pressure within air chambers **102A** and **102B** and/or **106A** and **106B**. In some implementations, the pressure of the air chambers **102A** and **102B** and/or **106A** and **106B** can be continuously monitored using one or more pressure sensors. In some implementations, the pressure of the air chambers **102A** and **102B** and/or **106A** and **106B** can be monitored via another method suitable for the application.

(74) FIG. **10A** is a cross sectional side view of another example configuration of components of mattress system **1004** that includes the air chamber **102A**, the air chamber **106A** (shown in FIG. **10B**), a lower air chamber **1000A**, a lower air chamber **1000B** (shown in FIG. **10B**), and a cover **112**. The lower air chamber **1000A** can be stacked with the air chamber **102A**. Thus, the lower air chamber **1000A** can be positioned below the air chamber **102A** and above the mattress cover **112** or positioned between the air chamber **102A** and another layer of the mattress system **1004** (such as a bottom foam layer, not shown). In the embodiment of FIGS. **10A** and **10B**, the air chambers **102A**, **106A**, **1000B**, and **1000B** are shown extending substantially a full length of the mattress **1004**. In alternative embodiments, the air chambers **102A**, **106A**, **1000B**, and **1000B** can extend less than a full length of the mattress **1004**, and can be combined with additional air chambers, foam supports, and/or other components positioned in the mattress **1004**.

(75) FIG. **10B** is a cross sectional head end **114** view of the example configuration of components of the mattress system **1004** in FIG. **10A** taken along section line **10B-10B** in FIG. **10A**. In this view of the mattress system **1004**, the lower air chamber **1000A** is stacked beneath the air chamber **102A**. The lower air chamber **1000B** is stacked beneath the air chamber **106A**. The air chamber **102A** can be fluidly connected via a hose **1002A** (or other suitable connector) to the air chamber **1000B**. The air chamber **106A** can be fluidly connected via a hose **1002B** (or other suitable connector) to the lower air chamber **1000A**. This cross connectivity configuration can be advantageous to maintain a relatively uniform level of a sleep surface across both sides of the mattress system **1004**, even when each side is adjusted to differing pressure settings. For example, a user can deflate the air chamber **102A** to a low pressure setting while another user can inflate the air chamber **106A** to a high pressure setting. Despite the difference in pressure settings, cross fluid connection via the hoses **1002A** and **1002B** can provide for balancing out the sleep surface.

(76) When both sides of the mattress system **1004** have relatively similar firmness, the mattress system **1004** can be relatively flat or even across the sleep surface. In some cases, one user can reduce firmness in the air chamber **102A** while another user can increase firmness in the air chamber **106A**. Without the cross fluid connection via the hoses **1002A** and **1002B**, the sleep surface of the mattress system **1004** may be uneven, such that the side of the mattress system **1004**

having the air chamber **106A** (which has been adjusted to be firmer) can be taller in height than the side of the mattress system **1004** having the air chamber **102A** (which has been adjusted to be relatively less firm). This uneven sleep surface can be undesirable for users of the mattress system **1004** due to comfort and/or aesthetics and may reduce overall sleep quality of the users.

(77) With cross fluid connection via the hose **1002B**, for example when the user increases firmness in the air chamber **106A**, firmness in the lower air chamber **1000A** can similarly be increased to raise (or to help maintain) a height of the side of the bed having the air chamber **102A**. The user may not feel the increased pressure of the lower air chamber **1000A** since the less firm air chamber **102A** is stacked on top of the lower air chamber **1000A**, but both sides of the mattress system **1004** can have a relatively flat or even sleep surface. Likewise, when the user decreases firmness in the air chamber **102A**, with cross fluid connection via the hose **1002A**, firmness in the lower air chamber **1000B** can similarly decrease to lower (or to help maintain) a height of the side of the bed having the air chamber **106A**. The user may not feel the decreased pressure of the lower air chamber **1000B** since it is stacked beneath the firmer air chamber **106A**, but both sides of the mattress system **1004** can have a relatively flat or even sleep surface.

(78) In some implementations, the mattress system **1004** may have the air chambers stacked as shown in FIGS. **10A-B** without fluid connection. In other words, the air chamber **102A** may not be fluidly connected via the hose **1002A** (or other suitable connector) to the air chamber **1000B**. Likewise, the air chamber **106A** may not be fluidly connected via the hose **1002B** (or other suitable connector) to the lower air chamber **1000A**. Such a configuration can still be beneficial to maintain a relatively even or flat sleep surface for the mattress system **1004**. This configuration can maintain a relatively even or flat sleep surface because one or more users can set unique pressure settings in each of the air chambers **102A**, **106A**, **1000A**, and **1000B**. For example, the user can input preferred pressure settings for one or more of the air chambers **102A**, **106A**, **1000A**, and **1000B** into a mobile application presented at a user device. Input provided in the mobile application can be transmitted to components of the mattress system **1004**, such as a pump controller, in order to implement the pressure settings. The user can also input preferred pressure settings for any of the air chambers **102A**, **106A**, **1000A**, and **1000B** using a remote control that is in communication with the mattress system **1004**. Sometimes, the pump of the mattress system **1004** can be configured to calculate optimal pressure settings for the lower air chambers **1000A** and **1000B** in order to maintain a relatively even or flat sleep surface regardless of pressure setting adjustments that the user makes to the air chambers **102A** and/or **106A**. The pump can also use a lookup table to determine optimal pressure settings for the lower air chambers **1000A** and **1000B** in order to maintain a relatively even or flat sleep surface.

(79) While this specification contains many specific implementation details, these should not be construed as limitations on the scope of the disclosed technology or of what may be claimed, but rather as descriptions of features that may be specific to particular embodiments of particular disclosed technologies. Certain features that are described in this specification in the context of separate embodiments can also be implemented in combination in a single embodiment in part or in whole. Conversely, various features that are described in the context of a single embodiment can also be implemented in multiple embodiments separately or in any suitable subcombination. Moreover, although features may be described herein as acting in certain combinations and/or initially claimed as such, one or more features from a claimed combination can in some cases be excised from the combination, and the claimed combination may be directed to a subcombination or variation of a subcombination. Similarly, while operations may be described in a particular order, this should not be understood as requiring that such operations be performed in the particular order or in sequential order, or that all operations be performed, to achieve desirable results. Particular embodiments of the subject matter have been described. Other embodiments are within the scope of the following claims. For example, in some embodiments the mattress **100** can include more or fewer foam structures and/or air chambers than those illustrated. Moreover, in some

embodiments the mattress **100** can include additional features not depicted, such as coil springs, comfort layers, sensors, or other support structures.

## Claims

1. A mattress comprising: a first air chamber; a second air chamber stacked directly beneath the first air chamber, wherein the second air chamber is fluidly connected to the first air chamber, wherein the first air chamber and the second air chamber have a common internal pressure when a user lies on the mattress; and a support stacked beneath the first air chamber and positioned between the second air chamber and a foot end of the mattress.
2. The mattress of claim 1, further comprising a foam layer positioned at a top surface of the mattress above the first air chamber.
3. The mattress of claim 1, wherein the first air chamber extends across a length of the mattress from a head end to the foot end of the mattress.
4. The mattress of claim 1, wherein the second air chamber is positioned at a shoulder region of the mattress.
5. The mattress of claim 1, and further comprising a hose or other suitable connector configured to extend between the first air chamber to the second air chamber and an air pump configured to be fluidly connected to one or more of the first air chamber and the second air chamber, wherein decreasing the common internal pressure in the first air chamber and the second air chamber causes the support stacked beneath the first air chamber and positioned between the second air chamber and the foot end of the mattress to increase support at a lumbar region of the mattress.
6. The mattress of claim 1, wherein one or more additional supports are positioned beneath the first air chamber and between at least one of (i) the second air chamber and a head end of the mattress, (ii) the second air chamber and the support, and (iii) the support and the foot end of the mattress.
7. The mattress of claim 1, further comprising a third air chamber stacked beneath the first air chamber and positioned between the support and the foot end of the mattress, wherein the third air chamber is positioned at a hip region of the mattress.
8. The mattress of claim 1, wherein an additional support is positioned beneath the second air chamber and the support and configured to extend across a length of a bottom surface of the mattress.
9. The mattress of claim 1, further comprising a foam rail structure including a head portion, a foot portion, and first and second side portions, the foam rail structure stacked beneath the first air chamber and configured to extend around a perimeter of the mattress to surround the second air chamber and the support.
10. The mattress of claim 9, wherein the second air chamber extends from a location adjacent to an inner surface of the head portion of the foam rail structure to a shoulder region of the mattress.
11. The mattress of claim 9, wherein the support extends from a location adjacent to the second air chamber to a location adjacent to an inner surface of the foot portion of the foam rail structure.
12. The mattress of claim 1, wherein the support comprises a rectangular open cell foam cushion positioned between the second air chamber and the foot end of the mattress at a location exterior to the second air chamber.
13. The mattress of claim 1, further comprising a first section extending longitudinally between a head end and the foot end of the mattress and extending laterally between a left side and a midline of the mattress, and a second section extending longitudinally between the head end and the foot end of the mattress and extending laterally between a right side and the midline of the mattress, wherein the first section comprises the second air chamber and the support, and the second section comprises a third air chamber and a second support positioned between the third air chamber and the foot end of the mattress, wherein the first air chamber extends across a top surface of the first section and the second section.

14. The mattress of claim 13, wherein: the second air chamber and the third air chamber have a different internal pressure, and the support within the first section has a first firmness level and the second support within the second section has a second firmness level, wherein the first firmness level is different than the second firmness level.

15. The mattress of claim 1, further comprising a first section extending longitudinally between a head end and the foot end of the mattress and extending laterally between a left side and a midline of the mattress, and a second section extending longitudinally between the head end and the foot end of the mattress and extending laterally between a right side and the midline of the mattress, wherein the first section comprises the first air chamber, the second air chamber, and the support, and the second section comprises a third air chamber, a fourth air chamber, and a second support positioned directly between the fourth air chamber and the foot end of the mattress, wherein the first air chamber extends across a top surface of the first section and the third air chamber extends across a top surface of the second section.

16. The mattress of claim 15, wherein the first air chamber and the third air chamber are fluidly connected via a first hose or other suitable connector to share a first common pressure and the second air chamber and the fourth air chamber are fluidly connected via a second hose or other suitable connector to share a second common pressure, wherein the first common pressure is different than the second common pressure.

17. A mattress comprising: a first air chamber positioned on a first side of the mattress; a second air chamber positioned on a second side of the mattress; a first lower air chamber positioned directly under the first air chamber, wherein the first lower air chamber is fluidly connected with the second air chamber such that the first lower air chamber and the second air chamber share a first common pressure; and a second lower air chamber positioned directly under the second air chamber, wherein the second lower air chamber is fluidly connected with the first air chamber such that the second lower air chamber and the first air chamber share a second common pressure.

18. The mattress of claim 17, and further comprising one or more air pumps configured to be fluidly connected to one or more of the first air chamber, the second air chamber, the first lower air chamber, and the second lower air chamber, wherein each of the first air chamber and the second air chamber are fluidly independent and independently adjustable.

19. The mattress of claim 17, and further comprising one or more air pumps configured to be fluidly connected to one or more of the first air chamber, the second air chamber, the first lower air chamber, and the second lower air chamber, wherein the mattress is configured to have a relatively level top sleep surface even when pressure is adjusted in the first air chamber and the second lower air chamber but not in the second air chamber and the first lower air chamber.

20. The mattress of claim 17, wherein the first air chamber is directly fluidly connected to the second lower air chamber and wherein the second air chamber is directly fluidly connected to the first lower air chamber.

21. The mattress of claim 17, wherein the first air chamber is connected via a first hose or other suitable connector to the second lower air chamber and wherein the second air chamber is connected via a second hose or other suitable connector to the first lower air chamber.

22. The mattress of claim 17, wherein the first air chamber is not fluidly connected to the first lower air chamber, wherein the first air chamber is not fluidly connected to the second air chamber, and wherein the second air chamber is not fluidly connected to the second lower air chamber.

23. The mattress of claim 1, further comprising a hose or other suitable connector configured to extend between the first air chamber to the second air chamber with no valve between the first air chamber and second air chamber.

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